

Project Description: EnviroCollective Network Website Redesign

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Overview

EnviroCollective Network (ECN) connects, convenes, incubates, and amplifies community sustainability action in Regina and area. Since incorporating as a Saskatchewan nonprofit corporation in 2020, ECN has built a network of environmental and civic partners and now runs several ongoing programs, including The Pollinator newsletter, the Repair Café and Smash Lab youth program, a Sustainability/Climate Expo, a Youth Empowerment Fund, a Resource Directory, Green Drinks/Teach-ins, and community Clothing Swaps.

Our mission is to network and share resources to support environmental and climate action; our vision is an inclusive community united in building a sustainable future. As ECN's programming has grown, our website has not kept pace, it still largely functions as a static brochure rather than as a resource residents can actually use to find our programs, our events, and our materials.

The Challenge

Like most volunteer-run nonprofits, ECN operates with limited staff time and no dedicated web developer. Our current site's structure and navigation are confusing, it does not reflect the programs we actually run today, it is not very visually appealing, and our resource library and past e-newsletter issues are difficult to search. Because the site is maintained by volunteers, any redesign needs to remain something our own people can keep updated, month after month, long after this class project ends, without specialized technical skill.

The Opportunity

As part of this course-based project, we're hoping students can help ECN move the site from an organizational brochure toward a working sustainability resource hub, a place where residents can find our programs, our resource library, upcoming events, and ways to get involved, not just read about who we are. The Calgary Climate Hub (calgaryclimatehub.ca), Indigenous Climate Action (www.indigenousclimateaction.com), and Climate Reality Project (www.climate realityproject.org) are examples of the kind of hub-style site we're drawn to. High-level guidelines, principles, constraints, and assumptions include:

- **Design approach:** Iterative check-ins matching the class schedule, low-fidelity concepts Oct 7, high-fidelity Oct 21, WordPress work-in-progress Nov 4, final delivery Dec 2.
- **Technology/Programming environment:** WordPress (ECN's current site platform).
 - We would like to explore other course tools such as Bookly for online Repair Café Bookings and WPConnect to connect to Airtable and manage our resource library
- **Initial design notes**
 - **Basic website criteria**
 - Home page
 - Reflect ECN's current programs and give a clear sense of what we do now
 - Engaging entry point into the resource hub, not just an intro paragraph
 - Program pages
 - A dedicated page per major program (Repair Café, Smash Lab, The Pollinator, Sustainability/Climate Expo, Youth Empowerment Fund) instead of one general page
 - Resource library

- Searchable and filterable, not just a static list
- Newsletter archive
 - Searchable index of past Pollinator issues
- Volunteer spotlights
 - Photos and short profiles of Repair Café volunteers, especially those who run their own repair businesses, with a way for visitors to contact them directly
- Get involved / contact
 - On-site newsletter signup, volunteer and donation calls to action, standard contact info
- About page
 - Mission, vision, history, board
- **Current website pain points to solve**
 - Navigation and site structure are confusing
 - Site does not reflect ECN's current programs
 - Overall visual design is not very appealing
 - Resource library and past e-newsletter issues are hard to search
 - Membership/donor sign-in is a nice-to-have we'd like explored, though it may be a bigger lift than the class timeline allows